



FIND YOUR HAVEN · CATALAN COAST

A Guide to Buying on the *Costa Brava*

2026 Edition

ROOTED IN ARCHITECTURE. FOCUSED ENTIRELY ON YOU.

What you'll find *in this guide*

This guide brings together, plainly and without filler, what any foreign buyer needs to know before buying a home on the Costa Brava or elsewhere on the Catalan coast: the real process step by step, the costliest and most common mistakes, and a first look at the areas where we work.

It isn't a sales pitch. It's the same judgement we apply with every client, boiled down to a few pages.

One tip before you read on. If you already have a specific property in mind, the most valuable advice in this guide is step 3: don't move forward without a technical assessment, whether with us or with any other serious professional.

The real process, *step by step*

1. Your NIE, before you need it

It's required to buy, open a bank account or set up utilities. Applying early stops you losing a good property while you wait for an appointment.

2. Your real budget, not just the asking price

Add transfer tax, notary, land registry and administrative fees and, where it applies, a renovation range from day one.

3. A technical assessment before you commit

Structure, roof, installations, planning status. It's the only thing that lets you negotiate with real data, not hope.

4. Reservation contract, reviewed by a professional

Penalty clauses, deadlines and a financing contingency if you depend on a mortgage: never a generic translated template.

5. Completion at the notary, and what follows

Land registry, transferring utilities, local property tax (IBI) and, if you won't live here full-time, fiscal representation as a non-resident.

The five *costliest mistakes*

1. **Buying from photos and video alone**, with no in-person technical assessment before committing.
2. **Underestimating the real cost of a renovation** in an older building, above all the roof, structure and installations.
3. **Signing a reservation contract from a generic template**, with no legal review tailored to the case.
4. **Not checking licences**: the occupancy licence, and whether earlier renovations were legalised.
5. **Coordinating everyone yourself**: agency, notary, architect and builder, none of whom know each other.

None of these mistakes is exclusive to inexperienced buyers. Almost always, they come from buying at a distance without someone working exclusively for you on the ground.

Five areas, *five characters*

Costa Brava

Coves, heritage and a well-established international market. Begur, Pals, Llafranc, Cadaqués.

€400K – €1.2M

Inland Empordà

Farmhouses and estates with a character of their own. Peralada, Ullastret, Monells.

€200K – €750K

Sitges / Garraf

An international landmark a short drive from Barcelona.

€350K – €900K

Maresme

Close to Barcelona, with a quiet coastal character.

€280K – €700K

Costa Daurada

Sun, long beaches and untapped potential.

€160K – €450K

Indicative market prices (2025–2026). Subject to change depending on the property, its condition and exact location.



What if the next step were *a conversation?*

This guide is the summary. What really changes the outcome of a purchase is having someone on your side from the first call, with no extra charge for the coordination.

Write to us and we'll reply within 24 hours, with specific questions and a clear first step.

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